

someone to offer one-on-one care several times a week. Because Julia's brother lives five minutes away from the facility, he is providing a lot of that care. The agreement that Julia and her brother have is that when their mother passes, he will get proportionately more of the inheritance. It's in the will. Julia is relieved and grateful to her brother and understands he should be compensated for all his work. In her mind, it isn't just a gift he is giving to her mother; it is a gift to Julia, too.

A quick note: an inheritance is a gift passed from your parents' lives to yours, and there is only one honorable way to use it. *That money has to reduce debt.* The minute you get it, keep 10 percent for your Secret 10 and use the rest to pay off the mortgage and any medical or credit card debt you have accrued. *Do not let yourself spend it on anything else if you have debt.* Pay off your debt first. Then and only then can you pass any extra on to your kids—and only if you want to.

Money Mistake: *You Lost Your Job, but Haven't Changed Your Lifestyle*

The Fix: *Go Back to Your 90-Day Number and Cut a Third of Expenses*

At a recent book signing, a man came up to me who had worked in the same industry for the past 28 years. He was making \$200,000 a year when he got laid off. The guy was 55 years old and no one would hire him. "I don't know what to do, Kevin," he said. "I'm supposed to take my whole family to Hawaii next month. We've been planning the trip for years. I can't cancel it."

I told him he not only *could* cancel it, he *had to*. Then I instructed him to go back to the 90-Day Number worksheet in my book. "Then cut one-third of your expenses until you can find another job," I suggested.

Families get in a lot of trouble when Mom or Dad loses a job. What usually happens is that they don't adjust their lifestyles. They're living under the assumption that Mom or Dad will get